BTC 8-Hour Market Report

Wed 21 Oct 2026, 15:51 Malaysia time (07:51 UTC)

BTC ~ $82,600

CoinGlass/CoinGecko: +1.0-1.3% 24h, -1.2% 7d

Quick view	**Bias:** Neutral, slight upside tilt inside range	**Next 24h range:** $81,000 - $84,200	**Key floor:** $81,300-81,700 (overnight low / 50-day MA), then $80,000	**Big event:** Oct 30 monthly expiry ($12.2B); FOMC 29 Oct 02:00 MYT

1. Options - next 24 hours and upcoming expiries

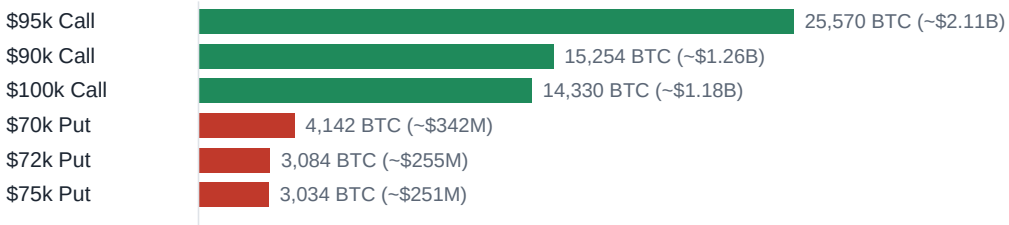
- **Next expiries:** today's daily rolls off at **16:00 MYT (08:00 UTC)** as this report goes out; the next one is **Thu 22 Oct, 16:00 MYT**. Weekly: **Fri 23 Oct, 16:00 MYT**.
- **How big:** daily expiries are usually small (size not readable this run). The Fri 23 Oct weekly holds about **14,759 BTC (~$1.22B)** - modest. The 16 Oct weekly was $1.47B with max pain $83,000.
- **Expiry that matters this week and next:** the **Fri 30 Oct monthly, ~$12.2B** (P/C 0.50-0.52, max pain $78,000-79,000). Its strike walls shape dealer hedging now.

Expiry	Largest position seen	Size	Meaning
22 Oct daily	Not readable this run	n/a	Small; little pinning power. Spot moves will be driven by flows/macro, not this expiry.
23 Oct weekly	Total OI 14,759 BTC (strike split not published)	~$1.22B	Mid-size. Likely mild pull toward the $82k-83k area into Friday 16:00 MYT.
30 Oct monthly - call	$95,000 Call	25,570 BTC (~$2.11B)	Biggest single position; far out of the money, a ceiling/target only on a big squeeze.
30 Oct monthly - put	$70,000 Put	4,142 BTC (~$342M)	Tail hedge; puts are thin, so the downside has less dealer 'cushion' above $75k.

Upcoming expiries

Expiry (Malaysia time)	Notional	Put/Call	Max pain	Largest strikes
Thu 22 Oct, 16:00 (daily)	Small (n/a)	n/a	n/a	Not readable this run
Fri 23 Oct, 16:00 (weekly)	~$1.22B	n/a	n/a	14,759 BTC total; strikes not published
Fri 30 Oct, 16:00 (monthly)	~$12.2B	0.52	$78,000-79,000	Calls $95k 25.6k, $90k 15.3k, $100k 14.3k; Puts $70k 4.1k, $72k 3.1k, $75k 3.0k BTC

30 Oct 2026 monthly expiry - largest open interest by strike (BTC, Deribit)



How options affect the market now

- **Call-heavy book (P/C ~0.5):** positioning is bullish on paper, but almost all call OI sits at $90k-100k, 9-21% above spot. These are lottery tickets, not a near-term wall; they only matter if BTC rallies hard toward $88k+, where dealer hedging (buying spot as calls go in the money) could speed a squeeze.
- **Max pain $78k-79k is below spot (~$82.6k):** into 30 Oct there is a mild gravitational pull lower, since option writers gain most if price drifts down. This is a weak force 9 days out and gets stronger in the final 2-3 days.
- **Thin put support:** put clusters are small ($70k-75k, ~3-4k BTC each). If $80k breaks, there is little options-driven buying until the mid-$70ks, so a drop could extend faster.
- **Volatility is cheap:** DVOL ~38 (near multi-year lows) vs 14-day realized ~20%. Implied daily move ~2.0% (~$1,650). Options price more movement than BTC is delivering - typical before a catalyst like FOMC; a volatility pop after expiry or

FOMC is likely.

- **Skew mildly defensive:** 25-delta risk reversals near -3 vol points - traders pay more for puts than calls short-term despite the call-heavy OI.
- **Next-24h expiry:** too small to move price. Treat the daily 16:00 MYT roll as noise; the Friday weekly can pin a little around $82k-83k.

Data note: the Deribit public API (index, DVOL, book summary) could not be reached this run, so next-24h strike-level OI is not shown and options figures come from published reports dated 17-20 Oct (CryptoTicker, TokenPost). USD sizes = OI x ~$82,600. Treat as 'largest seen'.

2. Price action and key levels

- BTC trades ~**$82,600**, up ~1-1.3% in 24h, after an overnight range of **$81,273 - $83,249** (2.4%).
- Daily closes have stayed between ~$81,400 and $83,100 since 12 Oct - a tight 9-day box. 7-day change -1.2%, 30-day +1.6%.
- Price sits just under the 20-day MA (~$83,100-83,300) and above the 50-day MA (~$81,500-81,700). RSI ~51: neutral momentum.
- Still ~34% below the $126,080 ATH (6 Oct 2025); early-October rally was rejected near $86,500-87,000.

Type	Level	Why it matters
Resistance 2	$85,300 - $86,600	Measured targets after a breakout; early-Oct rejection zone near $86,500-87,000
Resistance 1	$83,250 - $84,250	Overnight high, 20-day MA; a daily close above $84,246 is the clean breakout trigger
Pivot	$82,500 - $82,900	Middle of the 9-day box and the likely weekly-expiry pin area
Support 1	$81,300 - $81,700	Overnight low and 50-day MA; buyers defended it repeatedly
Support 2	$80,000	Big round number; break opens a fast move given thin put OI
Deep risk	$75,000 - $78,000	Max pain zone ($78-79k), $75k puts and the Sept low $74,968

3. Derivatives, flows and sentiment

Metric	Latest	Read
Futures open interest	~$53.2B (CoinGlass)	Large but steady; leverage not stretched
Funding (OKX perp)	+0.0034% / 8h (~3.8% ann.)	Mildly positive; longs not crowded
Liquidations 24h	A few hundred $M (down from ~$1B on 15 Oct)	Leverage flush is behind us; quiet tape
Options OI (all)	~$37.9B; calls 60% / puts 40%	Call-heavy; volume skewed to puts (57%) = hedging
DVOL (30d implied vol)	~38.3 (20 Oct)	Low; implied daily move ~2.0%
Spot ETF net flows	+$526.7M (19 Oct), +$23.2M (20 Oct)	Strong Monday (IBIT +$665M), then flat; Oct MTD ~ -$88M
Fear & Greed	63 (Greed), up from 55	Sentiment improving, not euphoric

4. News and macro

- **Fed:** FOMC 27-28 Oct, decision **29 Oct 02:00 MYT**. Rates 3.75-4.00% after a Sept hike; markets price ~85% hold, 12-15% hike; a December hike is ~80-90% priced. Fed in blackout.
- **Inflation/yields:** Sept CPI 3.7% y/y (above 3.6% est.), PPI 6.3% y/y; US 10-yr ~5.1%. A hawkish backdrop caps risk appetite.
- **Oil/geopolitics:** Brent briefly above $110 then eased on US-Iran indirect talks (via Pakistan/Qatar); tanker damage near Hormuz, Houthi-Saudi clashes; US-Ukraine talks in Norway.

- **Crypto flows:** US spot BTC ETFs +$527M on 19 Oct (biggest since Sept), only +$23M on 20 Oct. BlackRock filed for a new 'PBIT' Bitcoin ETF; FINMA approved Switzerland's first retail spot BTC ETF (listing Nov). Strategy added 267 BTC (848,517 total).
- **Regulation/exchanges:** Kazakhstan AIFC court restricts Coinbase, HTX, BingX and others; MEXC exits Russia/Belarus; SEC 'Regulation Crypto Assets' comment period closed 20 Oct.
- **Equities:** Meta and Tesla report after the US close tonight (~04:00 MYT Thu) - AI-funding jitters have been hitting tech and can spill into BTC.

Event calendar (Malaysia time)

When (MYT)	Event
Thu 22 Oct, ~04:00	Meta, Tesla, Lam Research, TI earnings (after US close)
Thu 22 Oct, 16:00	Deribit daily BTC options expiry
Thu 22 Oct, 20:30	US initial jobless claims
Fri 23 Oct, 16:00	Deribit weekly expiry (~$1.22B)
Fri 23 Oct, 21:45	S&P Global flash PMIs (US)
Sun 25 Oct	Brazil presidential runoff; Europe clocks change
Thu 29 Oct, 02:00 / 02:30	FOMC decision / Warsh press conference (no new dot plot)
Thu 29 Oct, 20:30	US September PCE (per Blockhead calendar)
Fri 30 Oct, 16:00	Deribit monthly expiry ~$12.2B, max pain $78-79k
Sun 1 Nov	US clocks change: US data then at 21:30 MYT
Early-mid Nov (TBC)	US October jobs report and October CPI

5. Summary and prediction

BTC is coiling in an $81.3k-$83.3k box with low implied volatility, mildly positive funding, improving sentiment (F&G 63) and a strong but uneven ETF bid. Options are call-heavy but the calls are far above spot, while max pain for the large 30 Oct expiry sits lower at $78-79k, so options add a slight downward pull rather than support. The next-24h expiry is too small to matter; the real catalysts are tonight's Meta/Tesla earnings, oil headlines and positioning into FOMC (29 Oct). Expect range trading with an upside test of $83.3k-84.2k more likely than not, but no confirmed breakout without a daily close above $84,250. **24h call: range $81,000-84,200, slight upside tilt; break of $81.3k flips bias bearish.**

Scenario	Chance	Range	Trigger
Base: range	55%	$81,300 - $84,000	No macro shock; ETF flows flat-positive; weekly expiry pins near $82-83k
Bullish breakout	25%	$84,250 - $86,600	Daily close above $84,250 with ETF inflows / strong tech earnings; shorts squeezed
Bearish break	20%	$79,000 - $81,000	Loss of $81,300 on oil spike, weak tech earnings or hawkish Fed repricing; drift toward max pain

- **Upside signal:** hourly/daily close above $83,250, then $84,250, with funding staying below 0.01%/8h (healthy, not crowded).
- **Downside signal:** close below $81,300 (overnight low / 50-day MA) - opens $80,000 and then the $78-79k max pain zone.
- **Next report: 11:50pm MYT (Wed 21 Oct)**

Sources

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